

Low-Carb Chickpea Idli (Eggless & Vegetarian)

A protein-rich, lower-carb variation of traditional idli made using soaked chickpeas instead of rice and lentils. These idlis are soft, filling, naturally gluten-free, and pair beautifully with coconut chutney or sambar.

Ingredients (Makes 8–10 Idlis)

- 1/2 cup dry chickpeas — soaked 8–10 hours and drained
- 2–3 green chilies
- 1-inch ginger piece
- Salt to taste
- 2 tbsp fine almond flour
- 1 tsp psyllium husk
- 2 tbsp thick curd or Greek yogurt
- 1/4 tsp Eno fruit salt OR 1/8 tsp baking soda (added just before steaming)
- Optional spices: cumin, coriander, hing, chopped coriander leaves, grated carrot

Preparation Method

- Soak chickpeas overnight and drain well.
- Grind chickpeas with green chilies, ginger, and 1–2 tbsp water into a smooth thick batter.
- Mix in almond flour, psyllium husk, curd, salt, and spices.
- The batter should be thick but pourable.
- Rest the batter for 10–15 minutes to hydrate.
- Add Eno or baking soda just before steaming and mix gently.
- Pour into greased idli molds.
- Steam for 10–12 minutes until fluffy and firm.
- Cool slightly before removing from molds.

Important Tips

- Do not add too much water while grinding.
- Psyllium helps retain softness and structure.
- Greek yogurt creates softer idlis and slight tang.
- Allowing batter to rest improves texture.

- Adding Eno too early may reduce fluffiness.

Texture Tweaks

- For softer idlis: add 1 tbsp more yogurt.
- For firmer/sandwich-style idlis: reduce yogurt slightly.
- For lighter texture: add 1 tbsp coconut flour.
- If batter is too thick: add 1 tsp water at a time.
- If batter feels thin: add almond flour or psyllium.

Variations

- Vegetable Version: add grated zucchini, carrots, spinach, or methi leaves.
- Herb Version: add coriander leaves, curry leaves, dill, or mint.
- High-Protein Version: add 1–2 tbsp unflavored whey isolate or pea protein.
- Paneer Version: fold in grated paneer for extra protein.
- Masala Idli Version: add crushed pepper, cumin, hing, and curry leaves.
- Fermented Style Version: rest batter 4–6 hours in warm place before steaming.

Serving Suggestions

- Serve with coconut chutney, mint chutney, or tomato chutney.
- Pairs well with vegetable sambar.
- Can be sliced and pan-toasted in ghee for a crispy snack.
- Works well as travel breakfast or lunchbox option.

Approximate Nutrition (Per Idli, based on 9 idlis)

- Calories: ~55–70
- Protein: ~3–4g
- Net Carbs: ~3–5g
- Fat: ~3g
- Fiber: ~2–3g

Storage & Reheating

- Store refrigerated for 3–4 days.

- Can be frozen for longer storage.
- Re-steam or microwave gently before serving.
- Pan-toasting leftover idlis in ghee gives excellent texture.